Yet such protests seemed to be having little impact on Curzon, and Chelmsford complained continually to Montagu that the government of India was being treated 'as if we were a quantité negligeable'.[91] *In December 1918, Montagu himself had threatened to completely withdraw India's share of Persian expenditure if the Foreign Office did not stop sending instructions to Tehran without prior approval from the India Office.*[92] *In response, Crowe argued that 'the attitude of the India Office is unreasonable. The fact is that the India Office do everything to substitute their authority for that of this dept., not only in Mesopotamia and kindred questions but also in regard to Persia, where, I gather, Mr Montagu is bent upon leading us into a policy of scuttle and complete abandonment of our position.'*[93] *This struggle over control of Persian policy was compounded by the Foreign Office's apparent disregard of the Indian government's opinion and its claim to expertise in Asian affairs. Despite the viceroy's assertion that the Indian government held 'a greater knowledge of the facts than they [the Home government] could possess',*[94] *the Foreign Office believed 'that knowledge and experience gained in Persia is to be found far more easily in London than it is in Simla or Delhi'.*[95] *This attitude Chelmsford attributed to the report of the Mesopotamia Commission 'which had blackened our faces in the eyes of the world and discredited us as a Government'.*[96]

Curzon, for his part, was growing increasingly impatient with Chelmsford's opposition. At an interdepartmental conference in May 1919 the acting foreign secretary blasted the government of India for refusing to underwrite a large loan to Persia needed to push through his planned reform package. The issue of finance was, indeed, the one ace up the viceroy's sleeve, for without India's resources the Home government would struggle to maintain its interests in Persia, let alone extend them (as Curzon was trying to do). Threatening to withhold such finance, as Montagu had done in December, was the one way of getting the Home government to listen to India. It had certainly caught the attention of Curzon, who fumed at the Indian government's attitude, arguing that the whole plan he was trying to enact in Persia was being carried out for the benefit of India in the first place, by creating a stable buffer state.[97] Curzon apparently failed to understand why the Indian government objected to being forced to pay for a policy that it opposed while all the while being scolded that it was for India's own good.